BRAND IDENTITY GUIDELINES

SABIN

Clarity for Creativity

SABIN IS AN ACOUSTICS AND LIGHTING COMPANY THAT ENGINEERS INTUITIVE SOLUTIONS TO ENABLE THE MOST INCREDIBLE HUMAN INTERACTION

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These brand guidelines serve as a visual and verbal representation of the Sabin brand's positioning. They are meant to guide, not to restrict. It enables a unified, positive, flexible, and future focus for Sabin. The following pages explain the multiple iterations of the Sabin identity system and the rules for using them correctly to create an inspiring and trustworthy brand. Please follow the guidelines carefully. The purpose of these guidelines is to help build and maintain a clear, consistent, and successful visual identity.

BRAND FRAMEWORK

INTRO
VISION
MISSION
VALUES
PROMISE
POSITIONING

The Sabin brand identity results from research, discussions, and efforts to provide verbal, visual, and related forms of expression. This enables our core vision and achievements to come alive and stand out in the world—to be distinct, recognizable, memorable, and, crucially, valuable to the markets that engage with our products and their experience of working with our team in various capacities.

SABIN IS THE FIRST COMPANY FOUNDED EQUALLY AS A LIGHTING COMPANY AND AN ACOUSTIC COMPANY—A PARADIGM SHIFT FOR THE INDUSTRY.

WE HAVE ASSEMBLED A TEAM OF VETERAN DESIGNERS AND ENGINEERS FROM WITHIN THE LIGHTING AND ACOUSTIC INDUSTRIES TO DESIGN AND BUILD BETTER PRODUCTS FROM THE GROUND UP.

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A MORE CREATIVE WORLD FULL OF BOLD IDEAS

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WE DESIGN ACOUSTIC AND LIGHTING SOLUTIONS FOR A CLEARER, BRIGHTER, MORE IMAGINATIVE TOMORROW

QUALITY OF LIFE

We are human-first in our thinking and in our desire to supply products that elevate quality of life—for all people.

With a deep empathy for people's needs and aspirations, we're dedicated to providing products that elevate the quality of life for individuals of all walks of life. Our designs don't just illuminate spaces; they enrich moments, inspire emotions, and create environments where people can thrive. We believe that everyone deserves access to products that enhance their well-being, and it's this human-first approach that drives every decision we make.

PRECISE ENGINEERING

We know our products—down to the Sabin. Our products are a testament to precision.

We live and breathe the details of our acoustic lighting solutions, ensuring that every facet and every component achieves high standards. From the inception of an idea to the final stages of production, we maintain an unwavering commitment to accuracy and quality. The result is not just acoustic lighting solutions, but finely crafted forms that exemplify the meticulous care and expertise that define the Sabin name.

SUSTAINABLE PROCESS

Where we are able, Sabin contributes to a brighter future for humanity—from more environmentally friendly materials, to more respectful working methods for all involved.

By intertwining environmental consciousness with our creations, we envision a world where lighting solutions not only illuminate spaces but also illuminate a path towards a sustainable and harmonious existence. Our commitment extends beyond the present.

INNOVATIVE DESIGN

We push the industry forward by creating original, solution-oriented products.

Our design ethos goes beyond aesthetics—it's about understanding the intricate interplay between form and function. We delve deep into the challenges, systems, and potential within our industry to craft products that set new standards for innovation. Our commitment to pushing the industry forward drives us to consistently engineer original, solution-oriented designs that not only solve problems but redefine possibilities.

METHODICAL CRAFT

Our hands-on processes give us unparalleled control over the materials we use and allow us to consider each other while we work.

It's in these intentional, careful methods that we find the balance between innovation and tradition, always considering the needs of each individual who interacts with our creations.

CREATIVE IDEAS

We believe in the power of bold ideas. Our artful approach empowers our team and our customers to bring new ideas to the world.

Our approach is rooted in embracing the unconventional, empowering both our team and our customers to be fearless innovators. Through our vision, we enable new concepts to take flight, helping individuals and spaces express their uniqueness and leave a timeless impact on the world.

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TO BRING CUSTOMIZATION, CLARITY, AND EFFICIENCY TO EVERY PROJECT

WHILE DELIVERING ON TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS AND ELEVATED DESIGN STANDARDS

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SABIN EXISTS AT THE INTERSECTION OF CREATIVITY AND PRECISION

SABIN IS THE ACOUSTICS AND LIGHTING PROVIDER THAT DELIVERS INTUITIVE SOLUTIONS FOR THE BUILT ENVIRONMENT —FOR THE ARCHITECTURAL, DESIGN AND CONSTRUCTION COMMUNITIES.

THESE SOLUTIONS ALLOW FOR CREATIVITY AND CUSTOMIZATION DUE TO OUR UNIQUE PROCESS AND PRODUCTS, AND ULTIMATELY CREATE AN INSPIRING AND EFFICIENT SPACE FOR ALL.

We help our customers reach their goals more effectively through integrated tools and flexible product design—ultimately, we are a platform to enable creativity and ensure precision.

Refer to the **INDEX** information at the end of this document to understand more about the strategic process behind this positioning.

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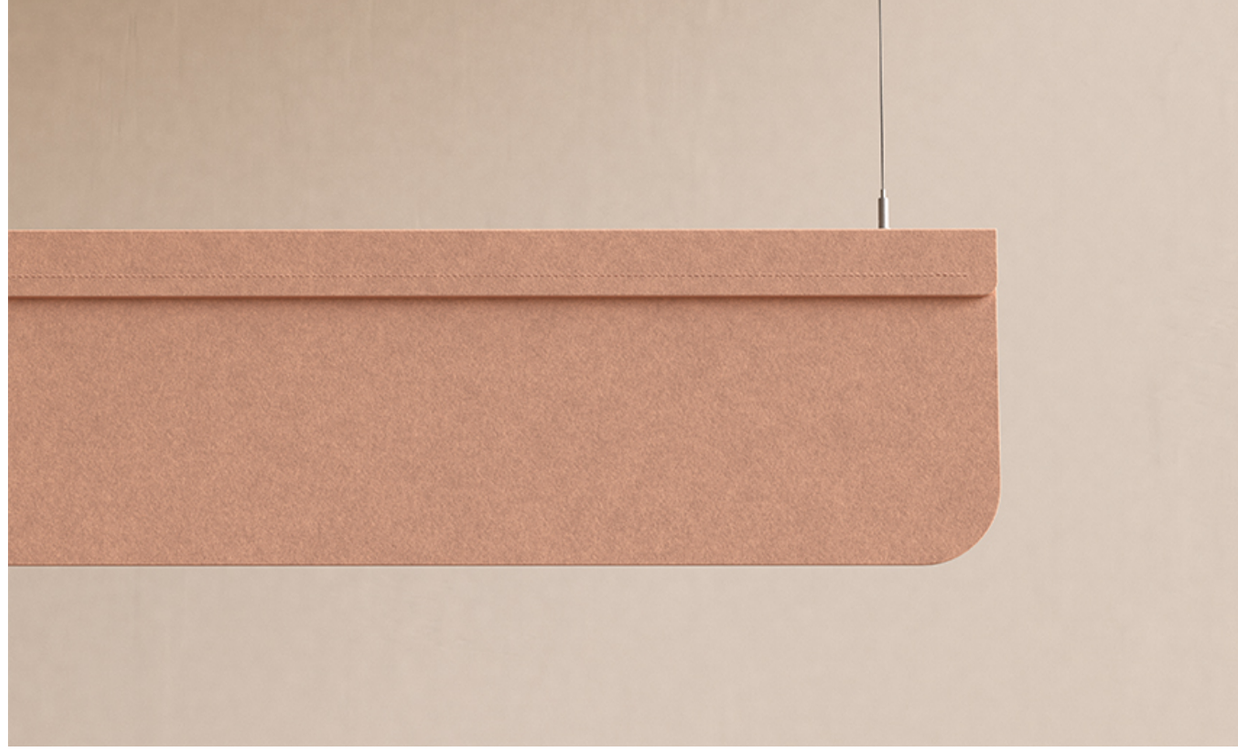
BRAND VOICE

OVERVIEW
NAME
TAGLINE
DESCRIPTORS
TONE
LANGUAGE
VOCABULARY
STYLE
WRITING GUIDE

Brand voice refers to the consistent and unique personality, tone, and style of communication that Sabin adopts in its messaging across various platforms and channels. It encompasses the language, vocabulary, and overall manner in which a brand communicates with its target audience, reflecting the brand's values, identity, and positioning in the market. Brand voice is not only a reflection of the character of Sabin, but also a powerful tool that fosters trust and loyalty over time.

FROM OUR NAME TO OUR LANGUAGE, AND ACROSS EVERY TOUCH POINT, WE ARE CLEAR, CONCISE, AND BALANCED.



We recognize the impact language holds over how people perceive Sabin. Consequently, every time we communicate is an opportunity to reinforce how Sabin expresses itself as a brand through written and spoken words.

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SA·BIN, NOUN:

A UNIT OF SOUND ABSORPTION, USED FOR EXPRESSING THE TOTAL EFFECTIVE ABSORPTION FOR THE INTERIOR OF A ROOM

Technical in definition with an understated phonaesthetic,
Sabin provides immediate context for the products we create.

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CLARITY FOR CREATIVITY

Our tagline balances our rational side with our imaginative side—referencing light and acoustics with a sense of optimism about the humans that interact in our spaces. It is an inspiring, memorable phrase that helps to create an emotional connection with our audience.

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DESCRIPTORS CONVEY THE KEY FEATURES OR BENEFITS OF OUR PRODUCTS, AND ARE USED IN INSTANCES WHERE IT'S IMPORTANT TO CREATE A SPECIFIC IMAGE OR ASSOCIATION IN THE MINDS OF CONSUMERS.

WHERE THE TAGLINE IS IMAGINATIVE, THE DESCRIPTORS ARE PRACTICAL.

Primary Descriptor

ACOUSTICS AND LIGHTING ENGINEERED WITH PRECISION AND CREATIVITY

Primary Descriptor is intended for instances where a descriptor of Sabin products is required. The Primary Descriptor does not replace the tagline.

Secondary Descriptor

ACOUSTICS + LIGHTING MADE IN CHICAGO

Secondary Descriptor is intended for instances where a descriptor of Sabin products is required, but with limited space. The Secondary Descriptor does not replace the tagline.

Tertiary Descriptor

ACOUSTICS + LIGHTING

Tertiary Descriptor is intended for instances where space is limited and a descriptor for Sabin products is required. The Tertiary Descriptor does not replace the tagline.

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OUR TONE IS CONCISE, CLEAR, INFORMED, AND CONSIDERATE.

WE ARE SOLUTION ORIENTED, PROACTIVE AND RESOURCEFUL WITH OUR WORDS.

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WHAT WE SAY

WE ARE INFORMED

We know what our customers need, and all of our output, including our products, processes, information—and words—extend from the fact that we understand. We are educated and sure in our communications.

WE ARE INSPIRING

We are thought-leaders, especially when it comes to our products and the way in which we design them. We introduce interesting, unconventional ideas. We are excited to talk about the incredible features of what we make, and the inspiring team that makes them.

WE ARE SOLUTION-ORIENTED

We approach everything with an eye for opportunity. We are realistic about how every project requires special attention to unexpected changes. We are familiar with navigating these issues and collaborate to design tailor-made solutions.

WE ARE PROACTIVE

We anticipate the needs of our partners as much as we can—from initial inquiries to product planning, production, and installation. Driven by the details, we use every tool in our toolbox to see through to the best result for every project.

HOW WE SAY IT

WE ARE WARM

We are human-first in our tone. Our priority is communicating clearly with our partners in a way that makes them feel like they belong, and we inspire the customer-as-designer with a tone that is empowering and certain.

WE ARE CONCISE

We are thoughtful, logical, and honest in our communication—and always resourceful—reflecting the same qualities as our products. Our word choice and word count are considered. We aim to provide clarity for our customers while understanding efficiency is a priority for all.

WE ARE UNIQUE

We value creative expression and each individual that collectively comprises Sabin. For this reason, every person that speaks for Sabin, speaks through the Sabin lens of presenting it in a warm and concise way. Individual talent is highlighted, and partners are recognized.

WE ARE AFFIRMING

Our customers are professionals and through our language we assure that we understand their needs. We do not teach or instruct, but we affirm. We create a sense of connection with our clients and convey that we're partners working to reach a common goal.

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RECURRING THEMES AND WORDS WE USE IN OUR LANGUAGE

DESIGN AND CUSTOMIZATION

Sabin product architecture is rooted in design thinking, and the Sabin team takes care to ensure a positive product integration exists with ambiance and aesthetics. Brand vocabulary should include words that describe the visual impact and sound-enhancing qualities of our acoustics and lighting.

Example words: Ambient, Interiors, Environment, Mood-enhancing, Aesthetically pleasing

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

As an acoustics and lighting company based in precision, demonstrating technical expertise and knowledge about lighting solutions, products, and technologies is important to include in our language. Brand vocabulary might include terms related to lighting design, energy efficiency, process technology, acoustics, design technicalities, and also may include statistics and numbers.

Example words: Technology, Photometry, Optics, Retrofitting, Acoustics, Reverberation

INNOVATION AND CREATIVITY

Sabin is committed to innovation and creativity in acoustics and lighting. Incorporating words that convey innovative thinking and unique design concepts will set Sabin apart.

Example words: Cutting-edge, Innovative, Visionary, Inventive, Inspired, Discovery

QUALITY AND RELIABILITY

Sabin offers high-quality and reliable acoustics and lighting products and resources, and these qualities should be conveyed through the brand vocabulary. Words that evoke trust, durability, and top-tier performance should be emphasized.

Example words: Premium, Dependable, Durability, Performance-driven, Tailored, Craft

RESOURCEFULNESS

Sabin is resourceful. Our products are designed as tools of abstraction, our processes are built to create efficiencies in our workflow, and we design programs that allow our customers to feel empowered. We take care to use language that emphasizes this unique attribute.

Example words: Strategic, Efficient, Optimization, Adaptable, Tactical, Initiative

CUSTOMER-EMPOWERING

Using vocabulary that speaks directly to the needs and preferences of customers can instantly connect us to our audiences. Use words and phrases that address specific customer challenges or enhance their experiences.

Example words: Solutions-focused, Enhancing experiences, Addressing needs, Useful

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AS A STANDARD, SABIN USES AP STYLE*

USAGE EXAMPLE

Acoustic and lighting systems can be used in a variety of applications, such as conference rooms, classrooms, and auditoriums, to create a more comfortable and pleasant acoustic environment.

Acoustic and lighting products are available in a range of styles and can be integrated into a space's lighting design in a variety of ways. They can be used in conjunction with other acoustic treatments, such as sound-absorbing panels or diffusers, to create a more effective acoustic solution.

*Headings are the only exception for non-standard formatting.
See the **WRITING GUIDE** section for more details.

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OUR NAMING CONVENTION ADHERES TO THE CONCISE AND DIRECT APPROACH OF SABIN. WE USE THIS APPROACH TO NAME OUR PRODUCTS, COLORS, AND OTHER ITEMS, FOCUSING ON BREVITY AND CLARITY.

THE NAMES WE CHOOSE FOR PRODUCTS, COLORS AND OTHER EPHEMERA SHOULD NOT BE DISTRACTING TO THE SPEAKER, AND SHOULD BE EASY TO PRONOUNCE.

Product Families

EX: LINEAR, BLOCK, QUAD, TRI

Product family names should describe the form and action of the unit. Practically, they should be one word—short—at no more than eight characters.

Individual Products

EX: LINEAR 9, LAYER OBROUND

“Individual products” refer to the product names within a product family. Some products from the core product line are named for the product family (like “Block”)—in this case there is only one of these per product family. Naming for individual products should primarily give an indication of form and function. There is no limit to character count, but names should uphold the Sabin standard for clarity.

Individual products always have a technical name that may be used interchangeably, but should follow the formula below. The only exception is the Linear product family that is simply a “L”.

3-LETTER PRODUCT FAMILY CODE (DASH) NUMBER OR LETTER

Examples: LYR-O, BLK-U, L-60

Color and Finishes

OBSIDIAN VS. BLACK

FELT — One word, no more than eight characters long, biophilic (i.e. -”OBSIDIAN”; “FLINT”)
NON FELT MATERIALS — Non-descriptive color names (i.e. “BLACK”; “GRAY”)

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USE “SABIN” OR “THE SABIN” WHEN SPEAKING ABOUT OUR COMPANY. DO NOT USE “SABIN’S”.

USE TITLE CASE WHEN WRITING OUT “SABIN”. DO NOT CAPITALIZE “SABIN” IN WRITTEN FORM (UNLESS OF COURSE THE ENTIRE SENTENCE IS UPPERCASE).

DO NOT USE AMPERSANDS OR PLUS SYMBOLS IN COPY. USE “AND”.

FOR ADDED VISUAL EMPHASIS, IT IS OK TO INCLUDE A SPACE ON EITHER SIDE OF THE EM-DASH.

ONLY USE SENTENCE PERIODS TO CONCLUDE A LARGE HEADING IF CHARACTER COUNT IS GREATER THAN 17, OR THERE IS MORE THAN ONE SENTENCE.

SABIN WRITING CHECK LIST

Write simply, for a human audience.

Use exclamation points sparingly, if at all. Do not use more than one exclamation mark at a time.

Do not use ellipses unless it is in a quotation format.

Do not use rhetorical questions, humor, or jokes.

Remove excessive adjectives. The more concise, the better.

When in doubt, re-write your sentence.

Don’t write so that you can be understood, write so that you can’t be misunderstood.

Use spell-check, and an AI writing tool, whenever possible.

Use respectful and inclusive language.

Adhere to AP style guidelines unless otherwise noted.

Ensure there are no orphans or widows.

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VISUAL IDENTITY

RATIONALE
LOGO
CLEAR SPACE AND SIZE
INCORRECT USAGE
COLOR
TYPOGRAPHY
GRIDS AND MARGINS
GRAPHICS
ART DIRECTION
APPLICATION
EXAMPLES

The Sabin visual identity is a crucial component of the overall identity and plays a significant role in shaping how Sabin is perceived. It consists of various visual elements, such as logos, colors, typography, imagery, and design styles, that collectively create a consistent and recognizable visual representation of the brand. The visual identity communicates the Sabin brand values, personality, and positioning.

THE SABIN VISUAL IDENTITY IS THE VISUAL EXPRESSION OF ITS BRAND POSITIONING THAT BALANCES CREATIVITY WITH PRECISION.

SABIN CORE VISUALS ARE CLEAN, CONCISE, STRUCTURED, AND GRIDDED, EVOKING A TASTEFUL UNDERSTANDING FOR THE WORLD OF ARCHITECTURE. THEY SERVE AS A RESOURCE AND FOUNDATION FOR DESIGN EXPRESSION, JUST LIKE SABIN PRODUCTS.

Sabin is pioneering something new by seamlessly integrating both acoustics and lighting from the outset. We approach products and customization with a balanced blend of creativity and precision, supported by automation. As a result, the Sabin visual identity follows this distinctive model, allowing our consumers and the market to experience and understand that our company and products are charting an exciting new path. This path is not only reliable but also characterized by creativity and design thinking.

Structured typography, minimalism, and gridded space are complemented by bold colors and occasionally unconventional layouts and analogue imagery. This visual system creates a classic, modular, design-conscious, inventive, dependable, and distinctly human visual identity. These elements together indicate that Sabin is enthusiastic about approaching things differently to achieve design-focused results, marking a paradigm shift for the acoustic lighting industry.

Logo

The primary logo serves as the clearest and simplest source of brand identification within the Sabin creative toolkit. It is designed to make a maximum visual impact across all applications. The Sabin minimal logo features a subtle slab serif ‘I’, referencing the precision and measurement evident in Sabin products. The strong, vibrant primary color mirrors the brand’s warm and innovative qualities.

The Sabin primary logo should be presented in the Orange brand color, but it can also appear in Yellow and Gray. In knockout applications, it should be displayed in White on Orange. The logo is primarily designed to be used in Orange on a White surface, or in White on an Orange or Yellow surface. As a secondary option, the logo can also appear in Yellow and Black.

The Orange or Yellow logo should never be used on Gray or Black

SABIN

SABIN

© SABIN

CLEAR SPACE

A minimum amount of clear space must surround the logo at all times to ensure visibility and impact. No graphic elements of any kind should encroach upon this zone. For the logo, this clear space is calculated based on twice the width of the vertical line in the 'I' from the Sabin logo. In general, it's advisable to maintain the maximum amount of white space possible around all sides of the logo to ensure optimal visibility. Please note that clear space differs from margins. Refer to The Sabin standards for margin application in the section titled **GRIDS AND MARGINS**.

LOGO SIZES *PRINT ONLY

Sabin applies (2) consistent sizes to the logo—only relevant for stationery and printed material. Both should be used as consistently as possible. See below.

SABIN 3.1" WIDTH

SABIN 0.8" WIDTH

© SABIN

Logo Incorrect Usage

Apply the logo assets in an image or vector form, and avoid these issues among many others.

DO NOT STRETCH OR SKEW

SABIN

DO NOT ROTATE

SABIN

DO NOT APPLY DIGITAL EFFECTS

SABIN

DO NOT APPLY INCORRECT COLORS

SABIN

DO NOT RECREATE IN ANY WAY

SABIN

DO NOT ENCASE IN A BOX

*with the exception of specific production executions (ex: tags, tape)

SABIN

DO NOT APPLY A STROKE

SABIN

DO NOT ADD DESCRIPTORS

SABIN

Lighting

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Color

The decidedly bold and bright Sabin color palette is referential to light, dependability, clarity, and bold creativity. Color also plays a vital role in serving as a means to highlight and compliment Sabin product colors which show up often in images. Orange is the primary color, while Yellow is a close secondary color—but the two are used selectively with the other brand colors to stand out and not to overwhelm.

ORANGE

CMYK	0 71 89 0
RGB	227 103 56
HEX	#F15C24
PANTONE	1655 C 1655 U

YELLOW

CMYK	1 25 68 0
RGB	255 193 94
HEX	#FFC15E
PANTONE	1365 C 1365 U

DARK GRAY

CMYK	81 76 71 41
RGB	48 48 48
HEX	#303030
PANTONE	439 C 439 U

WHITE

CMYK	0 0 0 0
RGB	0 0 0
HEX	#FFFFFF
PANTONE	NA

LIGHT GRAY

CMYK	8 6 9 0
RGB	229 228 220
HEX	#E5E4DC
PANTONE	WARM GRAY 1 C WARM GRAY 1 U

When adding color to marketing materials, charts, or presentations, use the supporting colors below, based on Sabin brand colors and Sabin felt and finish colors. If additional colors are needed, consider schemes that use colors next to each other on the color wheel.

Reference the **APPLICATIONS** section to see how to apply Sabin color standards.

#E5EECC	#D7E5EE	#DDD9E7	#EDD6D3
#BFD2A4	#969AB3	#DA7672	#F09199
#597C15	#3847A3	#6E2594	#c17a4b
#0A3322	#083D43	#1B1B48	#593843

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Typography use is the strongest brand identifier for Sabin after the logo and color. The identity's structure and visual communication heavily relies on the excellent application of typography and its hierarchies. Simplicity and conciseness are its core features. When in doubt, less is more.

There may be rare instances of technical programs that restrict brand fonts. In these cases, use Helvetica for sans serif and Times New Roman for serif replacements.

NEUE MONTREAL

Neue Montreal by *Pangram Pangram Foundry* is our primary font. It is a sans-serif font. The primary style is Medium, and should be applied in the format that the following pages describe. It not only holds a visual relationship to the logo, creating a more seamless brand experience, but it emphasizes the simple, modular, organized, and classic qualities of the Sabin brand.

Neue Montreal Medium Uppercase is used almost exclusively, with the exception of small, running text, which should appear in *Neue Montreal Light*. Bold can also be used for technical documents where multiple hierarchies are used.

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh
Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp
Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx
Yy Zz

MESSINA MODERN

Messina Modern by *Luzi Type* is our secondary typeface. It is a serif font. It is used to support Neue Montreal to add visual interest and infuse the brand with personality and a technical, yet classic, aesthetic sensibility. It should be used minimally and should not overwhelm any document.

Messina Modern Regular Title case is used almost exclusively in conjunction with *Italics Title case* when emphasis is needed, with the exception of technical names for products, which should appear in UPPERCASE.

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh
Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp
Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx
Yy Zz

A specimen for the use of Sabin typography is seen on the right and is correctly represented throughout this entire Brand Guidelines book.

Reference the **APPLICATIONS** section for how typography has been applied to maintain as much visual harmony as possible. Application of these hierarchies and styles will ultimately depend on the deliverable, but consistent use of scale and point size will allow for a stronger brand, reflecting our character that is precise, consistent and clear.

LARGE TEXT

FONT NEUE MONTREAL
STYLE MEDIUM
CASE UPPER

The primary font, Neue Montreal—applied in all caps and in the Medium style in large headings—is one of the strongest visual identifiers for the Sabin brand. The entirety of the text block must appear in the same color with the exception of cases such as advertisements grounded in a strategic rationale or a hover effect in digital applications. Word count should be concise.

In printed and digital matter, many of these headlines are set to 65 pt for a consistent visual presence.

MEDIUM TEXT 1

FONT NEUE MONTREAL
STYLE MEDIUM
CASE UPPER

Neue Montreal is used for medium text, aka subheadings or small paragraphs. This text does not need to be in full sentences, but it can be. When there are two or more sentences or more than 17 characters (as a sentence), use closing punctuation. Otherwise, do not use closing punctuation.

MEDIUM TEXT 2

FONT MESSINA MODERN
STYLE REGULAR
CASE UPPER

Messina Modern is useful with information that requires more visual interest. It should be used to support Medium Text 1, primarily in medium-sized paragraphs. Sentence case is used almost exclusively, with the exception of technical names for products, which should appear large and in UPPERCASE.

RUNNING TEXT

FONT NEUE MONTREAL
STYLE REGULAR
CASE SENTENCE

Neue Montreal should be used for any kind of paragraph or running text, to support sub-headings, for captions.

CREATIVE PRECISION

ACOUSTIC LIGHTING MADE IN CHICAGO

Messina Modern is the Sabin secondary typeface. It is inspired by drafting notes and original design manuscripts and should be used for subheadings, to support headings, it also may be used for medium-sized paragraphs to add visual interest.

Neue Montreal is the Sabin primary typeface and should be used for any kind of paragraph or running text, to support sub-headings, for captions.

NEUE MONTREAL IN ALL CAPS MAY BE USED FOR SMALL, DETAILED INFORMATION

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Grids and margins are key elements of the Sabin brand identity. Literally and figuratively, they provide the structure that is representative of our precise and technical proficiency.

Reference the **APPLICATIONS** section for how to apply Sabin grids and margins.

APPLY A GRID

MAINTAIN TIGHT MARGINS

AND UTILIZE ALIGNMENT AND SPACING TO LEVERAGE A LAYOUT THAT FEELS FRESH — WE ARE PRECISE, BUT CREATIVE!

SIMPLE GRID LAYOUTS = CREATIVITY

Utilize grids while keeping them simple. Apply content to the grid in an uncluttered manner. The experience we aim to provide our customers and team is one that allows breathing room. Our products and brand identity should convey clarity at every step.

Feel free to break the grid when necessary! The structure is open for experimentation, but always maintain enough to preserve the grid's integrity. A singular unique pop of color, a shift in paragraph indentation, a 90-degree rotation of a logo—when done sparingly—contribute to the imaginative aspect that Sabin excels in. These elements infuse the human characteristics of optimism and innovation that define the uniqueness of Sabin.

MARGINS AND ALIGNMENT

The Sabin visual identity primarily employs left alignment, with center alignment used for content deserving greater visual emphasis.

In printed collateral applications, a document margin of 0.25 inches should be consistently applied whenever possible. All stationery adheres to this standard, and brochures and other printed materials should follow suit. Larger printed items, such as signage, will have narrow margins tailored to their specific contexts.

In digital applications, measurements depend more on the parent entity. Social templates are aligned with their respective contexts, which serves as a useful reference for making informed judgments.

Certain use cases, like Cut Sheets, may necessitate a margin of 0.5 inches. This is an exception rather than the rule.

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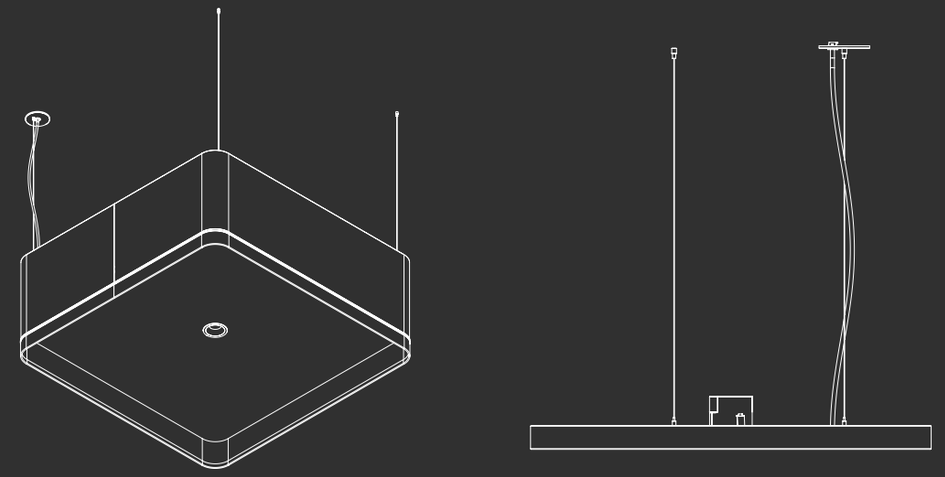
Graphics

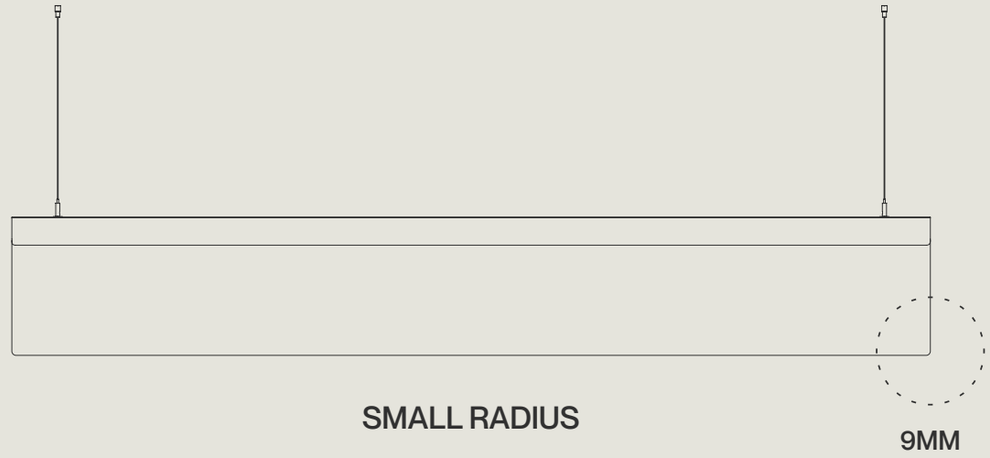
Sabin incorporates the graphic element of lines throughout its visual identity. The lines should be relatively thin compared to other content and rendered in the brand colors. In drawings, lines can highlight the technicality and creativity of our products.

These lines contribute technical precision and cleanliness to the visual identity while retaining flexibility for creative interpretation. One important guideline for line usage is that it should always have a purpose. Lines should never be employed purely as decorative elements.

For instance, lines can illustrate product features or separate information that might otherwise be unclear. However, they should not be used as borders unless those borders serve a functional purpose. If lines are not thoughtfully applied, their significance will be lost, diluting their value as visual elements.

Reference the **APPLICATIONS** section for how to apply Sabin graphics.





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Analog Visuals

Another distinctive visual feature of Sabin is the transformation of images, both photographic and vector, to evoke an analog or obsolete quality. This deliberate choice serves a significant purpose. By infusing our visuals with this analog feel, we effectively mirror the essence of our hands-on manufacturing process. Our utilization of manually operated machines and tactile operations is at the heart of what we do—ultimately driven by human expertise.

We embrace a more human and emotive connection, as they bring a warmth and authenticity that resonates on a deeper level. This tangible connection to our process not only conveys the dedication of our skilled team but also encapsulates the practical uniqueness that sets Sabin apart in the world of acoustic lighting.

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PHOTOGRAPHY

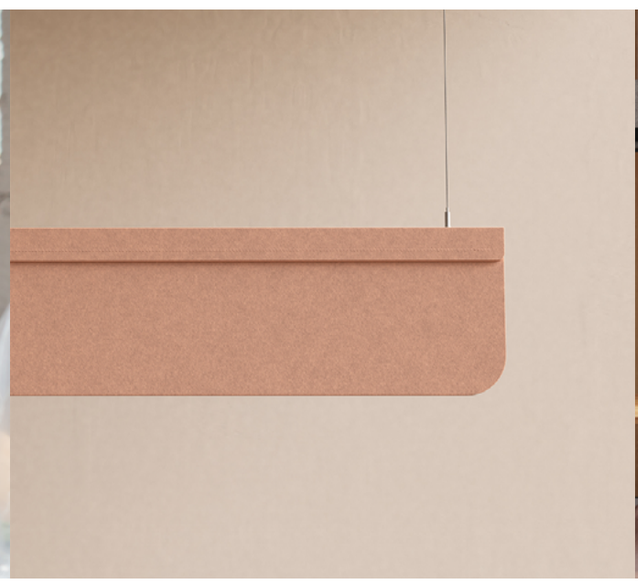
Sabin products, product environments, factory spaces, et al. should be photographed in a visually consistent way. The use of natural light in addition to any product light (for lit products) should be used in all brand photography, in a broad range from soft light to harsh light. No flash.

Reference the **IMAGE ART DIRECTION GUIDELINES** to understand additional details.

RENDERINGS

Sabin renderings for products and environments should be represented in a consistently visual way. Generally speaking, renderings should be uncluttered, minimal, and textural. Photo-realistic renderings should follow the same visual warmth, minimalism, and design-conscious principles of the brand.

Reference the **IMAGE ART DIRECTION GUIDELINES** to understand additional details.



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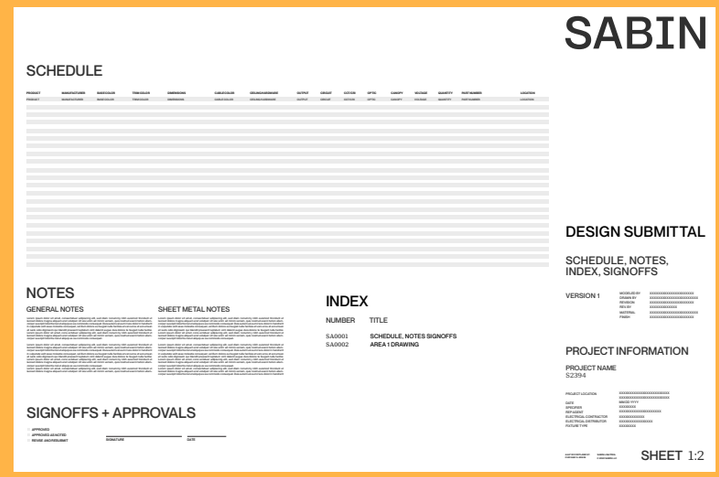
APPLICATION

PRINT SPECIFICATIONS
STATIONERY
LETTERHEADS
SIGNAGE
CUT SHEETS
PRESENTATIONS
DIGITAL EPHEMERA
SOCIAL

The application of a visual identity refers to the consistent and strategic use of visual elements, such as logos, colors, fonts, and design styles, across various communication channels and materials. It ensures that a brand or organization maintains a cohesive and recognizable appearance, reinforcing its identity and facilitating effective communication with its target audience.



Print Specifications

As much as possible, margins for printed matter should be set at .25”. One of the two logo sizes should be used (see **CLEAR SPACE AND SIZE** section) along with headlines to introduce content clearly, and is set to 65 pt size / 55 pt letting / -10 pt kerning.

Reference these examples, and templates created (stored in Sabin database) to easily apply these guidelines as printed material continues to be developed for Sabin. Copy/paste paragraph styles from existing documents to ensure consistency when creating new documents.

Color blocking is advised when applying color. Avoid decorative elements and excessive information.

SPECS

Generally, uncoated stock and minimal finishes should be used for printed matter.

PAPER

ORANGE
G.F. Smith Extract Ember
US Vendor: Paper Papers

YELLOW
Neenah Galaxy Gold

White, Dark Gray, and Light Gray tones have many options.
Use finish suggestions below

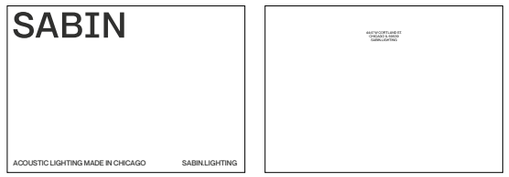
FINISHES

Uncoated finishes
Embossing
White Ink

Stationery

The Sabin stationery suite sets the precedent for how printed matter exists and extends in different touch points. The same size logo is used (see **CLEAR SPACE AND SIZE** section)—as well as consistent margins, type size, and interesting, but minimal, grid play. Color is used intentionally and with restraint, so that the moments where it is used are interactive and impactful.

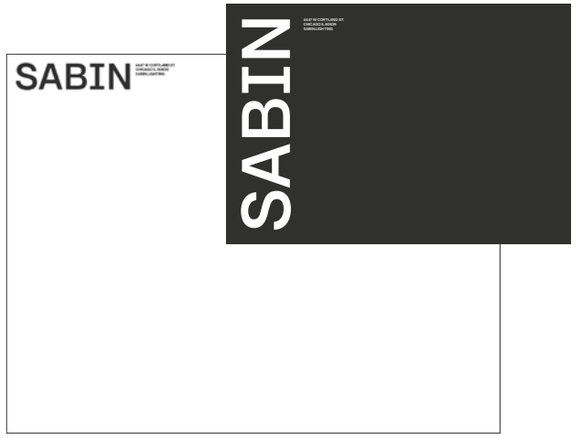
Utilize the templates created (stored in the Sabin database) to reproduce accurate stationery. The master templates are set in Adobe InDesign, but can be reproduced in other programs so long as formatting, color, type size, margins—everything—is identical.



A6 NOTECARD AND ENVELOPE

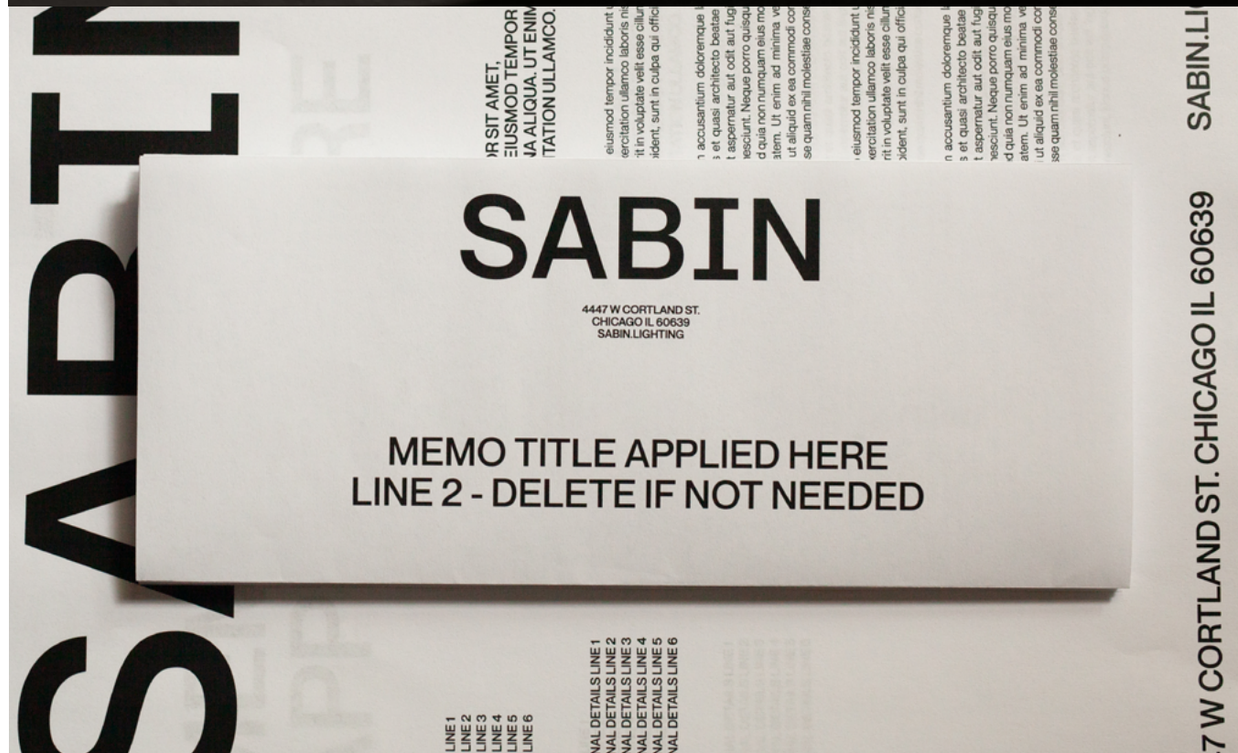
BUSINESS CARDS

MEDIUM ENVELOPE



LARGE ENVELOPE (1 OF 2, WHITE OR BLACK)

LETTERHEAD (1 OF 7)



Letterheads

The Sabin stationery comprises seven distinct letterheads, which are modular and adaptable, echoing the Sabin product philosophy. They are designed to suit a range of basic communication needs, both internal and external. Like all printed material, margins should be set at 0.25 inches. When applying a logo, it should be one of the two logo sizes specified (refer to the **CLEAR SPACE AND SIZE** section).

The templates created are stored in the Sabin database and offer variations with text areas as well as without, enhancing their flexibility. These master templates are created using Adobe InDesign, but they can be replicated in other programs as long as formatting, color, type size, margins—essentially all aspects—are kept identical.

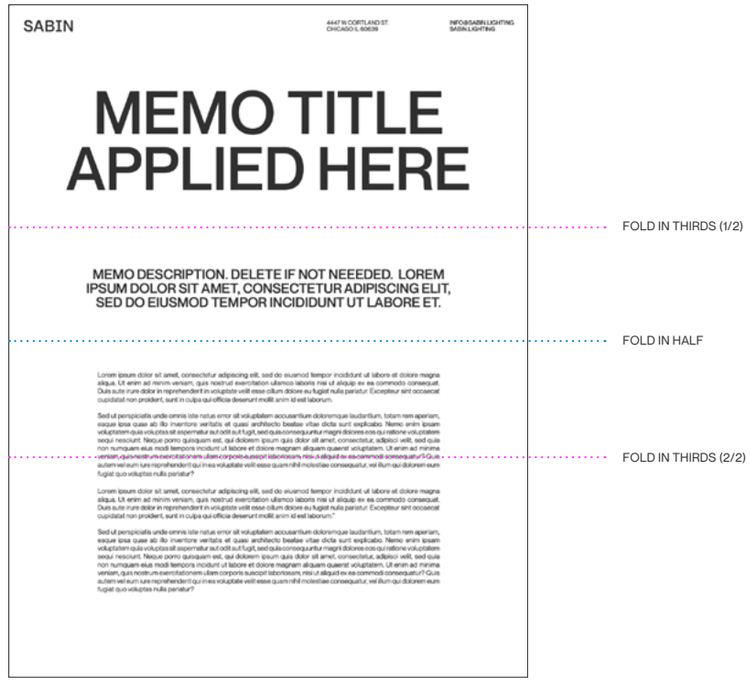
LETTERHEADS 1-3 ARE FLYER BASED AND UTILIZE A LARGE HEADLINE AND APPLY EITHER THE SMALL SABIN LOGO, OR PROMINENTLY DISPLAY THE SABIN WEBSITE.

LETTERHEADS 4-6 ARE EDITORIAL BASED AND UTILIZE THE LARGE SABIN LOGO.

LETTERHEADS 7-9 UTILIZE LAYOUTS RECOMMENDED FOR SPECIFIC USAGE REQUIRING A BIG BRAND PRESENCE, A UNIQUE PRESENCE, OR FOR LANDSCAPE ORIENTATION.

Letterheads can be applied on any brand color paper, with any brand color ink, following the color guidelines outlined in the **COLOR** section.

All letterheads are formatted to function for digital and print—or analogue, by writing on a printed version—with the option for printed version to be folded in half, or traditionally, in thirds.



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Signage

Signage should always appear in Neue Montreal Medium, UPPERCASE, and should follow the same guidelines for tight margins and leading. Line may be used as a graphic element only as it can serve a directional or functional purpose, not for any kind of decoration.

Reference these examples, and templates created (stored in the Sabin database) to easily apply these guidelines as signage continues to be developed for Sabin.

Packaging

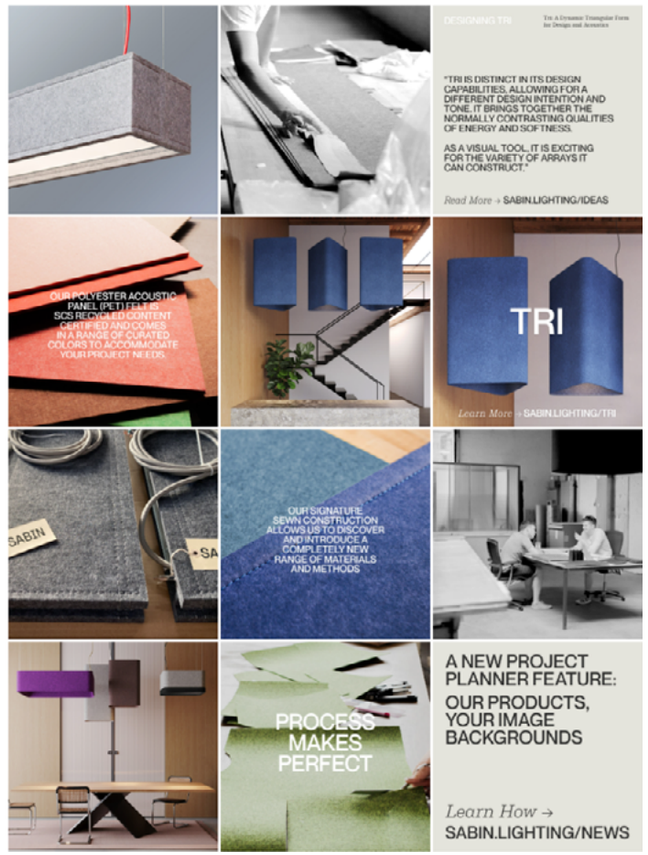
Packaging runs a large spectrum of content requirements, and therefore design needs, but should always be minimal and informative, leaning into boldness, simplicity, and color to make for a user experience that is easy to intake, fun, and at times—exciting.

Reference these examples, and templates created (stored in the Sabin database) to easily apply these guidelines as packaging continues to be developed for Sabin.

Social

Social content—visual and written—is an area where Sabin can share a larger spectrum of the exquisite products and experience that we offer. It is an area where Sabin can give the world multiple windows in which to see the outstanding quality of our output.

Reference these examples, as well as the **SOCIAL MEDIA GUIDELINES** and templates created (stored in the Sabin database) to easily create social content as it continues to be developed for Sabin.



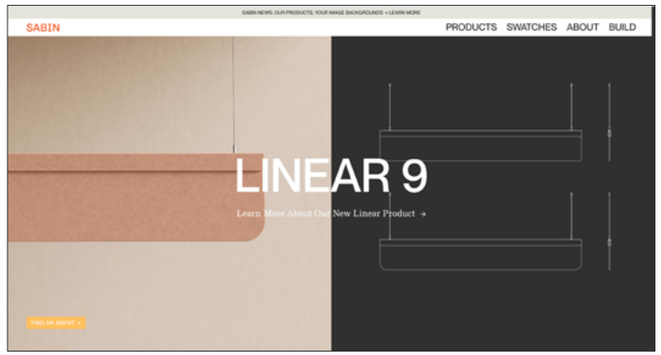
INSTAGRAM GRID SAMPLE

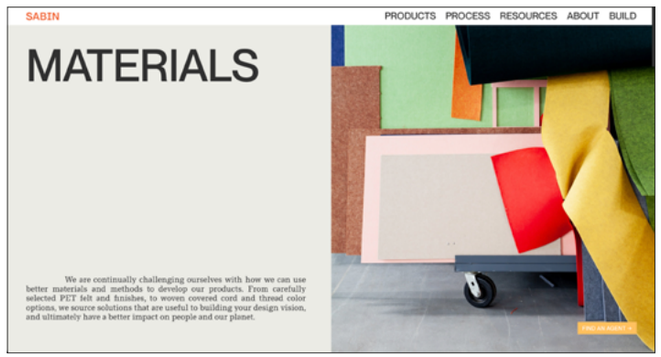
Digital Ephemera

Digital content, similar to social content, is an area where additional space has no “added cost”, and we should utilize this resource to share the spectrum of the Sabin brand identity experience. Whether it is the website, Project Planner, presentations, newsletter, or an evite, our promotional and marketing materials, no content should be crammed. All ephemera should reflect our concise and clear approach to communication—visually and otherwise.

If the digital deliverable is something that could be printed, it should be designed in that way. Sabin does as much as possible to create an experience for our customers and agents that makes their experience easier, and so we can design for dual-purposes (with dimensions for print, standards for print—rather than just for the purpose of digital—we should do that.

Reference these examples, as well as the guides and templates created (stored in the Sabin database), to easily apply these guidelines as digital content continues to be developed for Sabin.



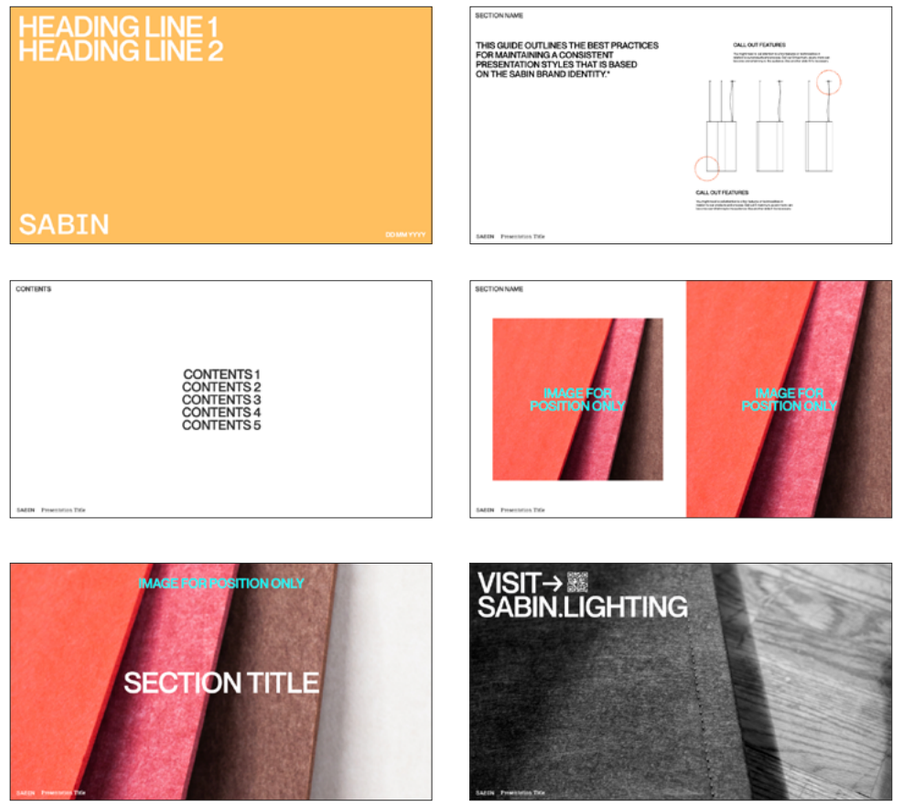


WEBSITE LAYOUTS

DIGITAL INVITATION

Presentations

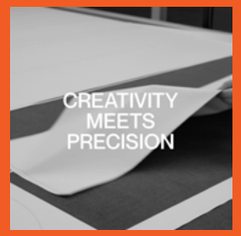
Reference the Sabin **PRESENTATION GUIDELINES** and the corresponding templates created (stored in the Sabin database), to easily apply these guidelines as digital content continues to be developed for Sabin.

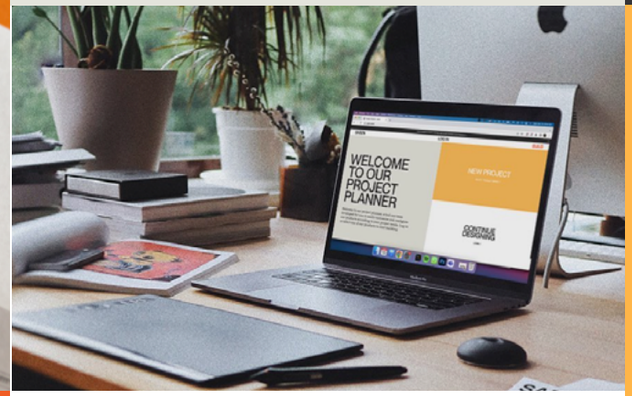


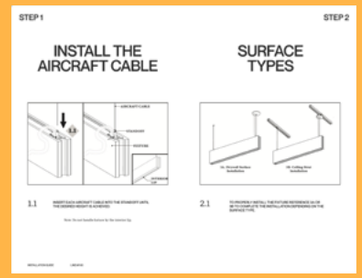
WEBSITE LAYOUTS

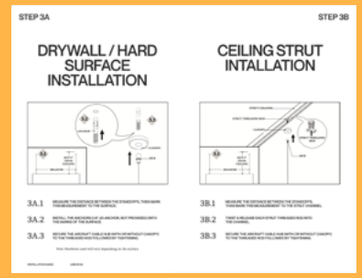
Et. Al.

Examples of merchandise, et al., that demonstrate the Sabin visual identity.









APPENDIX

FORMATION
POSITIONING DATA
CONTACT INFO

This section outlines the Sabin brand positioning process, preceded by an overview of the research and strategy that provided the foundation for its positioning. It is the framework that the Sabin brand identity was built upon, and should be used as a resource for understanding the groundwork that was established, as it provides the most pure basis for the company.

COMPANY ORIGIN

These statements represent the refinement of the original ideas for Sabin. It's the crux of its essence and the basis from which the company was originated.

Sabin exists in the balance of creativity and precision.

We value creativity just as much as precision. Classic balanced with imaginative. Dependable balanced with creative. Logical, methodical, and process-oriented, but also, dreamy, inventive, and exploratory. For the classic side, contract-business dependable, international style, timeless & structured is good but we also need to communicate that we have creative core, not corporate-design-by-committee.

Sabin aims to redefine industry standards in every department.

We want to make sense where both lighting and acoustic industries are confusing, even if it means spending more time to adjust customers to our new way of creating and sharing acoustic lighting. From our signature sewn construction to our color curation, from our internal processes to our external customer experience journey — Sabin is elevating industry standards for acoustics and lighting.

Notes

"Process oriented, but also, dreamy-inventive, exploratory."

"Sabin Lighting is an acoustic lighting company. We concentrate on this one area, and strive to offer the most competent acoustic lighting products on the market. We pursue a perfect balance of performance and price-point. We deliberately value human time and our planet. Because of this, we believe that excellent design is frugal design—we seek simplicity, and work to bypass time and material waste. Our goal is to deliver to our customers and users a durable solution to a clear problem, value by design."

"Possibly make use of semi-obsolete methods and media where it adds richness. For example, lots of drawings on paper, maybe film instead of digital, silkscreen instead of ink jet. It would be interesting to have presentations with a retrospective feel—process documentation, studio feel. The brand should feel like it is run by folks comfortable in art school, because it is."

Design Influences

Gio Ponti, Carlo Scarpa, Achille Castiglioni, Patricia Urquiola, Dieter Rams, Jean Prouvé

KEY WORDS

Classic
Imaginative
Dependable
Creative

ARCHETYPE STUDY

The Everyman meets The Creator.

As a brand we are intelligible, and driven by creativity. We see potential in every space around us, and want to make those spaces welcoming. We want to inspire "better" with our products—better communication, better ideas, and ultimately a better world. We care about people sharing ideas, spending time together, and existing in inviting and creative spaces. We're inspired by our journey and the journeys of those who interact with our products. We are celebrators of innovation and creativity for all.

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PROCESS

Refinement of the original key ideas for Sabin
Research of relevant markets
Identify the strategic opportunity for where key ideas and market overlap
Specify the positioning of Sabin

MARKET

Industries: *Acoustics and Lighting*

Sabin is situated between the lighting and acoustics industries. Several companies—many of our competitors—already walk the line between the two, but they either lean more into lighting or more into acoustics. Sabin is the first acoustic-driven lighting company that merges both offerings from the founding.

Sector(s): *Commercial Spatial Design and Construction*

A common language is spoken among the Sabin target customer market across both the lighting and acoustics sectors—the language of architecture and the creative built environment.

Competitors

DIRECT — Focal Point, Buzzispace, Turf, Luceplan, Light Art, LuxxBox, Acoufelt, Impact Acoustics
INDIRECT — Abstracta, Baux, Fact Design, Habitat Matter, Flexxica

Competitor Conclusions

IMPERSONAL IMPRESSIONS — Sterile or cluttered visuals are everywhere, and everything largely feels impersonal. The audience is forced to figure out where is what - and why. We have the opportunity to stand out feeling personal and authentic in how we visually communicate.

QUANTITY NOT QUALITY — Sabin products are directly speaking to the architect and interior designer. And, regardless if you are not either one of those, interacting with our product and our brand should be visually engaging—because of our world today, looking good is more important than ever.

OUTDATED PRODUCT APPLICATION — Product application is almost exclusively in outdated office environments. Public spaces, including offices, are shifting to a layout and furnishing style that brings the homey feel of residential furniture into the workplace. Meanwhile, our society generally is more interested in integrated work/living spaces including hotels. Resimercial design celebrates commercial quality, residential-inspired features over the sterile and standardized feel of corporate furnishings.

INFORMATION HEAVY AND UNCLEAR — Cluttered visuals and text are everywhere, and most websites are difficult to navigate. Products are often listed in endless scrolls or multiples, with little categorization or thought for how to streamline product offerings. This makes it difficult for the customer to navigate, which is poor customer service.

THOUGHTLESS OPTIONALITY — Many companies offer endless color options instead of curated ones, which allows for more tasteless selections. Our artistic approach to colors, materials, and feel deliver a more natural, more intuitive product for our clients.

USA COMPANIES LOOK THE SAME/OUTDATED — Acoustic companies like Abstracta and Baux are already aware of the importance of bringing a human sensibility and design consciousness to their brand and offerings.

DIFFERENTIATION

Sabin is built to enable creativity and efficiency, a resource of integrated tools for design expression. Not a gallery of inflexible products.

ACOUSTICS AND LIGHTING FROM INCEPTION — We're the first company in the world founded as an acoustic lighting company.

METHODICAL PROCESS — Our systems approach runs throughout our workflows creating more streamlined offerings with more optionality, as well as efficiencies across manufacturing, distribution, contracting, and building maintenance. These systems give us a leg-up on our competition.

DESIGN-DRIVEN SYSTEMS — Our product designs are coherent, logical, and feel simple. This simplicity is beautiful, honest, and highly versatile.

CURATION AND SELECTION — Many companies offer endless color options instead of curated ones, which allows for more tasteless selections. Our artistic approach to colors, materials, and feel deliver a more natural, more intuitive product for our clients.

HUMAN-FIRST — The user experience is important to us, and we want our customers to feel that their project—as well as the people the project is for—is a priority. The ideas for our products start with humans, so it is our goal that humanity is felt across Sabin touch points. We're speaking and designing acoustic lighting in a human way.

RETHINKING CUSTOMIZATION — We're creating easy avenues for customization through our product planners.

AUDIENCE

We are speaking to the architect, interior designer, contractor, and lighting designer. They need to feel that we can deliver for their project, and that we are design competent.

Our target audience appreciates both the precision and creativity in Sabin products. They notice the intuitive detail and easy-to-navigate system approach of our designs, and recognize that our streamlined processes establish efficiencies across the entire life of a project; and between architect and contractor, lighting designer and interior designer.

Sabin products are speaking directly to design conscious—but not pretentious—consumers. And, regardless if you are not an interior designer or architect, interacting with our product and our brand should be visually engaging. Looking good is more important than ever.

Profiles

ARCHITECTS — Architects create designs for new construction projects, alterations and redevelopments. They use their specialist construction knowledge and high-level drawing skills to design buildings that are functional, safe, sustainable and aesthetically pleasing. However, the design is the driving force throughout the project and beyond. They aim to not only deliver on a project, but

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are motivated to impress and achieve recognition in the field of architecture. They are motivated by creativity, performance, aesthetics, and recognition. Other motivations included self-identity, pursuit of quality in design, enjoyment and awareness of impact on people, and for some these motivations could be linked to incorporation of sustainability principles in their designs.* *Examples: Gensler, IA, HDLC, Perkins Will, HOK, RPBW*

LIGHTING DESIGNERS — Lighting Designers are responsible for the design, installation, and operation of the lighting and special electrical effects used in a space or production. They aim to create lighting within the built environment that enables occupants to see clearly and without discomfort. The objective of architectural lighting design is to balance the art and the science of lighting to create mood, visual interest and enhance the experience of a space or place while still meeting the technical and safety requirements. They are motivated by performance, customization, aesthetics, affordability, maintainability. *Examples: Artemide, Trio,*

INTERIOR DESIGNERS — The Interior Designer will create functional, safe, and aesthetically pleasing spaces by assessing space requirements, determining optimal furniture placement, and selecting decorative items, all while adhering to relevant blueprint, building code, and inspection requirements. They aim to develop a visual experience that seeks to compel and inspire, weaving together design and details to ensure that when completed, each project makes an immediate and lasting impact. They are motivated by performance, aesthetics, creativity, customization, materials, and color. *Examples: KAI, Stonehill Taylor, Meyer Davis, PLD, 555.*

CONTRACTORS — Contractors are managers who oversee all the aspects of a project. They arrange and manage the materials, workers, equipment and services needed for completing projects on time and within budget. They aim to minimize disruption in day-to-day operations, reduce risk, save time and money and deliver increased return on investment. They want their clients to feel proud and excited about a beautiful, new space. They are motivated by performance, clarity, efficiency, answers to questions, reliability. *Examples: Greiner.*

Audience Interests and Resources

ARCHITECTURAL DIGEST, IES LIBRARY, ARCHITECTURAL MAGAZINE, FURNITURE/OBJECT DESIGN, TEXTILE DESIGN, SALONE MILANO, DESIGN ANTHOLOGY, IIT CHICAGO

Audience Inspiration

Inspiration for our target audiences are a mix of industry “greats” (both people and companies) Reminding our audience of the initial inspiration of why they do what they do brings a feeling of illumination and desire.

Not all of our target audience has strong creative inspiration, but all of our target audience wants to be impressed with it. The fact that we look and feel like creative legends helps our audience understand we are serious about product design and forming company structures to sustain continued success.

Audience Collective Motivations

AESTHETICS AND DESIGN INTEGRATION — Acoustic lighting combines lighting fixtures with sound-absorbing materials seamlessly. It allows these professionals to maintain the desired aesthetics of a space while also addressing acoustic challenges, such as reducing noise and echo, which are crucial for creating comfortable and productive environments.

FUNCTIONAL IMPROVEMENT — Acoustic lighting not only provides illumination but also contributes to noise control. This is particularly valuable in open-plan spaces, large rooms, or areas with hard surfaces that tend to amplify sound. By investing in acoustic lighting, these professionals can improve the overall functionality of their designs and ensure better user experiences for the occupants.

VERSATILITY — Acoustic lighting comes in various forms, including pendant lights, wall-mounted fixtures, and ceiling panels. Its versatility allows architects, interior designers, lighting designers, and contractors to incorporate acoustic solutions seamlessly into their projects without compromising on design or space functionality.

CLIENT SATISFACTION — Ultimately, these professionals are motivated by client satisfaction. Acoustic lighting offers a competitive advantage by providing a holistic solution that enhances both the visual and acoustic aspects of a space. Satisfied clients are more likely to recommend their services, leading to increased business opportunities and a strong reputation in the industry.

Audience Conclusions

The target markets of architecture, interior design, lighting design, and contractors all have a common interest in creating aesthetically pleasing and functional spaces for their clients. They are driven by a shared desire to enhance the overall design and ambiance of a building or space.

Our target audience appreciates both the precision and creativity in Sabin products. They notice the intuitive detail and easy-to-navigate system approach of our designs, and recognize that our streamlined processes establish efficiencies across the entire life of a project; and between architect and contractor, lighting designer and interior designer.

Sabin products are directly speaking to design conscious—but not pretentious—consumers. Interacting with our product and our brand should be visually engaging, providing an experience that communicates excellence and design literacy.

OPPORTUNITY

We have the opportunity to introduce new standards for acoustic lighting by helping our audience reach their goals more effectively through integrated tools and flexible product design—ultimately, a platform to enable creativity and ensure precision.

We have the opportunity to pioneer a refreshing path in a jaded lighting market, with the advantage that Sabin is the first acoustic and lighting company, giving us the opportunity to introduce a new way to develop products and processes, and a new way to perceive and interact with acoustic lighting. We are the thought-leaders in acoustic lighting.

Goals

To inspire the architect, interior designer, contractor, and lighting designer—to see that Sabin is building acoustic lighting products and processes differently—tools designed to enable our customer. and help them reach their goals efficiently.

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BRAND IDENTITY AND GUIDELINES

CREATED BY LINDSAY COX FOR SABIN
08 2020

UPDATED 05 2024

SABIN
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CHICAGO IL 60637
SABIN.LIGHTING

VISIT→ SABIN. DESIGN

SABIN

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SABIN.DESIGN
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